vios
meaningful gastronomy

DELIVERABLE · ONE GALLERY

Worked example — ONE Gallery, Sofia (draft v0.1)

VIOS Practice · Part IV format (seven sections) · drafted 2 Nov 2026 by Vios (Claude) · **status: early draft, not the case**

Why a draft now: Part IV says a case is written three to six months after close, once the lesson has clarified; ONE Gallery has not closed (Stages 1–4 are in a revision pass, the marketing loop runs). This draft exists so the practice has one case in the house format with every number it can stand behind today and every gap named; it is rewritten at the engagement harvest. Nothing here is a result claim. Numbers: only those on file (`clients/one-gallery/`); everything else reads "to confirm".

1. The brief

ONE Gallery is a contemporary art gallery with a café and aperitivo bar on the ground floor, in the centre of Sofia (Dyakon Ignatiy 1A; founded May 2015, in the current space since Nov 2017), founded and curated by Desislava Zafirova. Open daily 10:00–00:00 with the exhibition open whenever the café is; the day runs Caffetteria (10–16), Golden Hour (16–18), Aperitivo (18–00). Revenue lines beyond food and drink: art sales, venue hire, an online shop, children's workshops, readings. Google listing 4.7 stars from 186 reviews (read 26 Oct 2026).

The founder's starting position: the brand strategy was already built (Brand Book v2.2, Oct 2026) and the four stages had been delivered once (Journey Map v2.2 EN/BG, Journey Design v2, Choreography, Operations Brief, Training Plan v2, Exhibition Workflow v2). What did not match it was the live presence: website, Google listing, two Instagram accounts; the reviews praised warmth and calm and never named a work, an artist or the Gallery Series.

Scope of the current engagement (signed per the founder 2 Nov 2026; date and file to confirm): a revision pass across Stages 1–4 on the house method, plus the marketing loop (calendar, copy, QA, engagement, monthly report). Approver: Menelaos Koulouris, interim, until ONE Gallery names one. Out of scope: the Exhibition Workflow (venue-specific operations, no counterpart in the four stages).

2. The brand strategy that emerged

As it stands at Brand Book v2.2, confirmed by the diagnosis of 26 Oct 2026; no change proposed.

- **Purpose**: lower the barrier to contemporary art through the rituals of coffee and aperitivo, so art is part of daily life.
- **Vision**: Sofia's cultural living room, the place the city returns to.
- **Mission**: welcome every guest the same; coffee and aperitivo above the city's standard; art to be approached, not deciphered.
- **Values and the behaviour that proves each**: Welcome (the greeting holds when late, busy or short-staffed) · Ritual (the defining moments are never improvised) · Discovery (short, clear context, never a lecture; staff wait to be asked) · Quality (a bad espresso is remade; wilted citrus is not used).
- **Primary persona**: Dilyana, 34, communications manager, Sofia centre; Explorer 70 / Lover 30; before: bored, compromising, hesitant about art; after: proud, belonging, curious. Lives next to Aesop, Monocle, COS, Aperol, independent cafés (affinity audit speculative until ground-truthed).
- **Second audience**: collectors, artists, curators, press; served through channels, never through a different welcome on the floor.
- **Positioning, Brand Role, Connection statement, archetypal mix, differentiator**: Brand Book v2.2 §3.2 and §6 (internal, never copy); transcribed in `clients/one-gallery/brand-book.md`.
- **Filter test** (derived 1 Nov 2026): *Is this a lecture?* Markers: explains unasked · assumes expertise · tells her how to see · more than one sentence of context before an invitation.

Open against this section: the owner interview is drafted from the book and awaits Desi's confirmation; the Brand Affinity Audit is unvalidated with guests; the numbers page is empty (no POS export yet).

3. The journey map

Journey Map v2.2 (Oct 2026; Drive › one gallery new › 01 Brand; EN and BG): 28 moments in 8 phases. Signature ★ M13; peak ◉ M18; end ⊐ designed as two moments, M24 + M25; six silent moments. Reasoning Note and Stage 3 Handoff from May 2026 (practitioner files). The weights were assigned before the house observation move existed; under the revised method (Move 2b, adopted 1 Nov 2026) every HIGH is read as brand-led until two shadowed services and the review read are on file, and a re-weighting date is set. Both are open.

4. The journey design

Journey Design v2, Choreography v2, Operations Brief v2 (Drive › 02 Operations, EN and BG): one DO / SAY / DON'T page per moment in the house layout (current state, do, say in registers, don't, non-verbal, behavioural economics, recovery, state arc, metric, target emotion, pillar); the moments around the peak designed as one cluster in the choreography, where a helpful act anywhere in the cluster breaks the peak; the end carried by two moments designed as one (an invitation offered once, then a specific person's farewell); an eight-section operations brief (staffing by daypart, boxed service-flow assumptions, equipment, standards as observable metrics, review cadence). Recovery designs: in the design document; the list is to be transcribed into the repo at the revision pass. The peak and the end in depth: at the revision pass, from the design pages.

5. The training programme

Journey Training Plan v2 (Drive › 02 Operations): for a running venue, five sessions by weight, foundations first and alone, HIGH before MEDIUM before LOW, silences last and never skipped, then shadow shifts and a signed checklist; three drills (retreat without the glance back; the silent moment under a clock; welcome symmetry). Coaching infrastructure as applied: to confirm at the revision pass. Under the house proof set (Nov 2026): no certification roster, no behaviour counts, no thirty-day audit exist yet for this client; all three are planned for the revised Stage 4.

6. The lesson (provisional)

What ONE Gallery taught the practice that it did not already know, as it stands before distance:

1. **The signature and the peak are different moments.** The differentiator made visible (M13) and the emotional high point (M18) sat five moments apart; designing them as one would have flattened both. The manuscript had one marker; the practice now carries two (★ and ◉).
2. **The end can be two moments designed as one**, and the peak-end rule holds across the pair only if the first is an invitation offered once and the second is a specific person.
3. **The peak needs a cluster, not a page.** Helpfulness near the peak broke it in rehearsal; the choreography had to protect the moments around the peak, not only the peak.
4. **A gallery-café's filter test is about lecturing**, not about selling: the category default the brand refuses is explanation, and every line fails or passes on that.
5. **Delivered documents are not proof.** The four stages existed in full and the live presence still did not match the brand; reviews never named the art. The practice had no instrument that would have shown this before the marketing review did. This is the lesson that produced the month-0 baseline, the outcome KPIs and the training proof set (quality plan, Nov 2026).

Lesson 5 is the one most likely to survive distance; lessons 1–4 are pattern candidates until a second engagement uses them (Atelier's blind map, 1 Nov 2026, reproduced 1 and 2 without seeing this client).

7. What changed in the manuscript

From this engagement, recorded in `docs/dry-run-2026-11-01-one-gallery.md` (harvest entry) and `docs/changelog-proposals.md`:

- Candidate patterns S2-06 signature marker, S2-07 two-moment end, S3-09 the DO / SAY / DON'T page, S3-10 the peak cluster, S3-11 eight-section operations brief, S4-08 onboarding by weight, S4-09 the three drills, S1-06 two brand-book formats, S1-07 the revision pass. Each used once; promotion needs a second engagement.
- Framework revisions adopted 1 Nov 2026: Stage 2 Move 2b observe before weighing, with the re-weighting date; `vios-ads-audit` winner rule 50 results per cell; guardrails evidence / contested / house-doctrine tiers.
- House decisions: Format A (interrogation order) is the brand-book standard; the journey map's house form (markers ★ ◉ ⊐ ○, per-phase tables, target state as a guest quote).

The numbers this case can show today

Measure	Value	Source, date	n
Google rating · reviews	4.7 · 186	Google Maps, 26 Oct 2026	186
Recent reviews read	warmth and calm in 10 of 10; art named in 0 of 10	`data/2026-10/google-reviews_…`	10, too small to call
Covers, revenue, average check, daypart, mix	to confirm	no POS export yet (blocker)	—
Marketing reach, followers, bookings	to confirm	no Metricool brand yet (blocker)	—

What makes this a case with a result, by the Stage 1 revision proposal: a month-0 baseline (`data/baseline-2026-11.md` from the POS export and Metricool), at most four outcome KPIs in the proposal's "What we aim to move" table (candidates the founder has not yet named: share of reviews naming a work or an exhibition; Gallery Series orders per week; covers in Golden Hour; bookings through the venue's own channel), and the thirty-day register audit after the revised Stage 4. Until then this document is a method case, not a result case.

Written by: Vios (Claude) · to be rewritten at harvest by: the account manager · reviewed by: Menelaos Koulouris (interim approver)